

Movement & Recovery Protocol

Train Smart, Recover Smarter

The Movement Mandate

Movement is medicine. But more isn't always better.

The goal: Optimize, don't maximize.

Weekly Movement Target:

- 3-4 strength sessions (45-60 min)
- 2-3 cardio sessions (20-30 min)
- Daily movement (10,000 steps)
- 1-2 active recovery days

Strength Training Framework

Focus: Compound Movements

Push:

- Push-ups
- Bench press
- Overhead press

Pull:

- Pull-ups
- Rows
- Deadlifts

Legs:

- Squats
- Lunges
- Step-ups

Core:

- Planks
- Dead bugs

- Pallof press

Program:

3 sets x 8-12 reps

2-3 min rest between sets

Progressive overload weekly

Cardiovascular Training

Zone 2 Cardio (80% of cardio work):

- Heart rate: 60-70% max
- Can hold conversation
- 30-45 minutes
- 2-3x per week

Benefits:

- Mitochondrial health
- Fat oxidation
- Cardiovascular fitness
- Stress reduction

High-Intensity (20% of cardio work):

- Sprints, intervals
- 15-20 minutes
- 1x per week
- Full recovery between sessions

Daily Movement Baseline

10,000 Steps Per Day

How to hit it:

- Morning walk (2,000)
- Lunch walk (2,000)
- Evening walk (2,000)
- Incidental movement (4,000)

Benefits:

- NEAT (Non-Exercise Activity Thermogenesis)
- Improved insulin sensitivity
- Mental clarity
- Stress reduction
- Better sleep

Recovery Protocols

Sleep: 7-9 hours (non-negotiable)

Nutrition:

- Protein: 0.8-1g/lb body weight
- Carbs: Replenish glycogen
- Hydration: Body weight (lbs) ÷ 2 = oz

Active Recovery:

- Walking
- Swimming
- Yoga
- Stretching

Passive Recovery:

- Massage
- Sauna
- Cold plunge
- Compression therapy

The Recovery Stack

Daily:

- 7-9 hours sleep
- Proper nutrition
- Hydration
- 10,000 steps

Weekly:

- 1-2 active recovery days
- Mobility work (15 min)

- Foam rolling (10 min)

Monthly:

- Deload week (reduce volume 40%)
- Massage or bodywork
- Assessment & adjustment

Sample Weekly Schedule

Monday: Upper Body Strength + Walk

Tuesday: Zone 2 Cardio

Wednesday: Lower Body Strength + Walk

Thursday: Active Recovery (Yoga/Stretching)

Friday: Full Body Strength + Walk

Saturday: HIIT or Sports

Sunday: Long walk, mobility work

Adjust based on:

- Recovery capacity
- Stress levels
- Sleep quality
- Energy levels